FIN-001 · Personal finance

Household monthly budget

Replace the sample figures before you rely on the result.

Use this when payday arrives and the month still feels vague. The sample is a two-adult household with R32,500 net pay and R2,500 from a Saturday stall. Nothing in the sample is a recommendation.

How to use the workbook

1. Type your own net pay in Inputs. Use the amount that reaches the bank, not the gross salary.
2. Replace every expense with the amount you expect to pay this month. Delete a row's amount if it does not apply, but do not delete the formula rows on Summary.
3. Read Summary before you move money. Surplus is income minus the costs you listed.
4. If surplus is negative, reduce a cost or the buffer before you promise a savings transfer.

Worked example

The sample income is R35,000. Listed costs are R28,099, so the plan shows R6,901 left.

- Rent of R9,500 is 27.1% of income in the sample.
- The buffer is listed as a cost so it is not spent by accident.
- Medical aid in the sample is an example contribution, not a product suggestion.

A practical routine

- On payday, update Inputs and the debt line first.
- On the 15th, replace estimates with what you have actually spent on groceries, transport, and electricity.
- At month end, write one sentence in the note column about what surprised you.

This workbook organises figures you type in. It is not financial, credit, insurance, or tax advice. Rates, fees, and laws change. A qualified adviser should review decisions that affect debt, tax, medical cover, or retirement.